

Firearms Trace Data: Alabama - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Alabama in Calendar Year 2023

10,440

Firearm Types with an Alabama Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	7,771
Rifles	988
Revolvers	756
Shotguns	560
Receivers/Frames	214
Machinegun Conversion Devices	60
Derringers	41
Machineguns	37
Other*	13

* Other includes Unknown Types, Combinations, Silencers and a Destructive Device.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with an Alabama Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	4,399
.40 Cal	1,138
.380 Cal	718

.22 Cal	634
.45 Cal	481
12GA	408
.38 Cal	374
7.62mm	337
MULTI	324
5.56mm	232

NOTE: There were 1,041 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 354 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Alabama Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	3,067
Possession of Weapon	1,547
Found Firearm	1,440
Dangerous Drugs	1,286
Property Crimes	492
Weapon Offense	427
Family Offense	385
Homicide	301
Traffic Offense	290
Aggravated Assault	198

NOTE: There were 1,007 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with an Alabama Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Alabama	7,503
Georgia	303
Florida	186
Mississippi	171
Tennessee	140
Texas	91
Louisiana	53
Ohio	44
Kentucky	38
North Carolina	36
Indiana	35
Virginia	28
South Carolina	26
Michigan	23
Missouri	22

NOTE: An additional 34 states and Puerto Rico accounted for 234 other traces. The source state was identified in 8,933 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Alabama Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	736
3 Months to Under 7 Months	631
7 Months to Under 1 Year	671
1 Year to Under 2 Years	1,385
2 Years to Under 3 Years	1,166
3 Years and Over	4,100

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Alabama Average Time-to-Crime: **5.92 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Alabama Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	349
18 to 21	1,033
22 to 24	863
25 to 30	1,290
31 to 40	1,547
41 to 50	795
Over 50	1,265

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Alabama Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Alabama Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Birmingham	1,682
Huntsville	1,513
Mobile	1,398
Montgomery	616
Hoover	584
Tuscaloosa	516
Anniston	208
Troy	200
Opelika	194
Gadsden	168

NOTE: There were 284 additional municipalities that accounted for 3,333 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 28 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Alabama. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Alabama.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with an Alabama Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Alabama Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with an Alabama Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Alabama Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Alabama Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Alabama Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024